

October 9, 2025

Riley Mahlman				
Wisconsin				
Left Tackle				
Height: 6080	Weight: 318	Year: 5SR	Jersey #: 71	Hometown: Lakeville, MN
Games Reviewed: Miami (OH), Middle Tennessee, Alabama, Maryland				
2025 Stats:				
Career Stats:				
Scouting Report by: Danny Nolan				

Critical Factors					
Reactive Athleticism		Anchor/Play Strength		Body Control	
6		6		5	
Positional Factors					
Run Block	Pass Block	Awareness	Footwork	2nd Level	Range
6	5	6	6	7	6
Hand Use	Power	Sustain	Finish	Flexibility	Toughness
5	5	7	4	5	5

Strengths

- Sustaining blocks throughout a play
- Attacking defenders at the 2nd level
- Recognizing and handling stunts

Weaknesses

- Physicality to finish blocks
- Handling speed against the pass
- Staving off defenders with forceful hands

Overall

Riley Mahlman is an imposing OT for a zone-heavy Wisconsin offense. He has played in 38 career games, starting 36 of them. Of the 5 games he has played this season, 4 have been at LT. Outside of that, all his appearances have come at RT. Mahlman sustained a left knee injury in 2022, causing him to miss 6 games, but has been healthy since that season. He has a basketball background, and that is evident in his athleticism and quickness, which are impressive for someone of his stature. At 6'8", 318 lbs, Mahlman has the power to dominate smaller defenders and the agility to contain bigger ones. He has a high football IQ and never takes a play off, but he lacks the edge to strike fear into opposing rushers.

Run Game

Mahlman has clear ability in the run game, and his mobility lends itself well to a zone blocking scheme. He has the lateral quickness to be a difference-maker on outside runs and the strength to generate a good push on the interior. He is very good at moving up to the second level and picking up linebackers or defensive backs. He sustains those blocks well, allowing plays to develop and allowing ball carriers to rip off chunk gains. At the snap, Mahlman attacks defenders, initiating contact and showcasing his play strength. Most of the time, he generates a good push and establishes a running lane. Occasionally, his aggressive nature causes him to lunge forward and get beat by defenders with quick hands and feet. Mahlman knows how to seal defenders based on the play design, and he is not overly prone to penalties. If he is moving laterally towards the inside of the field, he will get beat by a DT with strong hands. He has not been used as a pulling lineman as a Badger, but his athleticism suggests that is an area where he could thrive.

Pass Game

In the pass game, Mahlman has proven to be an anchor on both the right and left side. He has shined when faced with DL stunts, demonstrating the awareness and intelligence to recognize the action and the body control to contain his new assignment. He is rarely beaten by bull rushes from an edge, swallowing up those who try it with his 6'8" frame. However, he struggles against speed rushers, lacking the hand use to keep them at bay. Once he latches on to a defender, he sustains his block with a firm base throughout the duration of the play. Pancake blocks are few and far between for Mahlman. At times, Mahlman has a tendency to keep his hands too high. He has the talent to compensate for that in college, but it may be something he needs to address at the next level. Screen passes illuminate his smooth mobility, as he has no trouble getting out in space and clearing the way for the pass catcher.

Last Word

Due to his athleticism, Mahlman profiles as a starting LT in the NFL. His experience on the left side in college is limited, but he has all the tools to stick there as he becomes more comfortable. He has spent most of his college career at RT, so he could be used as a starter there as

well. His fluidity and quickness indicate that he would be best suited for blocking in a gap scheme, despite doing so infrequently at Wisconsin.

One-Liner: Mahlman is an experienced, intelligent tackle who sports impressive mobility but lacks dominant speed or power.

Grade: 6.7 - Ceiling: 6.9 (15%) Floor: 6.3 (30%) Round: 3